

STRAWBERRY DREAM BOOTIES

SIZES 44 TO 92

Classic baby booties with a rounded foot, a folded rib cuff, leaf tips and i-cord ties at the ankle. Four sizes, covering the whole collection, garment sizes 44 to 92.

Small

size 44-50

Medium

size 56-68

Large

size 74-86

Extra large

size 92

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Little Montessori Explorers

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Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. Test knit version 1.0

BEFORE YOU START

The booties are knitted from the top down. The deep rib folds outwards in wear. After the eyelet round and the leaf panel, the instep is worked back and forth as a small flap. Stitches are then picked up along both sides of the flap, and the foot and sole are shaped with decreases.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a deep, folded rib cuff
- making an eyelet round for i-cord ties
- shaping the instep, heel and sole
- knitting two identical booties

DIFFICULTY

Easy to slightly experienced. Picking up along the flap is the only new step, and it comes out most even if you pick up in the outermost whole stitch, not in the edge thread.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The booties are graded in four sizes, not nine like the garments. One leaf repeat is 8 stitches, approx. 3.8 cm round the ankle, and a foot grows far less than that between two neighbouring sizes. Measure the foot from heel to longest toe, and choose the size just above that measurement.

Small

size 44-50

Medium

size 56-68

Large

size 74-86

Extra large

size 92

WHICH SIZE TO CHOOSE

Size	Fits garment size	Foot length	Ankle circumference
Small	44-50	7,5 cm	11,4 cm
Medium	56-68	10,0 cm	15,2 cm
Large	74-86	12,5 cm	19,0 cm
Extra large	92	14,5 cm	22,9 cm

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Cast on	Leaf repeats	Cuff before folding	I-cord per bootie
Small	24 sts	3 x	5 cm	30 cm
Medium	32 sts	4 x	6 cm	36 cm
Large	40 sts	5 x	7 cm	42 cm
Extra large	48 sts	6 x	8 cm	48 cm

The foot length is the measurement that matters. The ankle circumference is deliberately generous, since the rib is folded and the ties draw it in to the right width.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop, the rounds are very small
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and grafting the toe
2 stitch markers	for the beginning of the round and centre front

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
Small	15 g	15 g	5 g
Medium	25 g	20 g	5 g
Large	35 g	25 g	5 g
Extra large	45 g	30 g	5 g

GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

TIME KNOTTING

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1 • RIB, EYELETS AND LEAVES

Cast on in green, join in the round and work *k2, p2* until the rib measures the height in your column. The rib will later be folded outwards. Work 1 round in knit.

Size	Cast on	Rib	Leaf repeats round
Small	24 sts	5 cm	3 x
Medium	32 sts	6 cm	4 x
Large	40 sts	7 cm	5 x
Extra large	48 sts	8 cm	6 x

EYELETS AND LEAF TIPS

Work the eyelet round: *k2tog, yarn over, k2*, repeat round. Work 1 round in green. Then work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, repeated as many times as your column says, so that the green narrows down towards the pink foot. Work 2 rounds in pink.

2 • THE INSTEP

Place the centre front stitches on one needle and leave the rest on hold. Work in stocking stitch back and forth over these stitches for the number of rows in your column. Work 2-3 cream seeds as you go, scattered over the flap. End with a right side row.

Size	Stitches round	Centre front	On hold	Rows back and forth
Small	24 sts	9 sts	15 sts	12
Medium	32 sts	11 sts	21 sts	14
Large	40 sts	13 sts	27 sts	17
Extra large	48 sts	15 sts	33 sts	20

The flap is the top of the bootie, the part that shows most. The seeds should therefore sit in the middle of it, not right out at the edges.

3 • PICK UP AND SHAPE THE FOOT

Work the flap stitches, pick up along the first side of the flap, work the held stitches, and pick up along the second side. Place the round marker at centre back. Work 4 rounds in pink.

Size	Flap	Pick up each side	On hold	Total	After 3 decrease rounds
Small	9 sts	6 sts	15 sts	36 sts	24 sts
Medium	11 sts	7 sts	21 sts	46 sts	34 sts
Large	13 sts	9 sts	27 sts	58 sts	46 sts
Extra large	15 sts	11 sts	33 sts	70 sts	58 sts

THE DECREASES

Decrease at the four corners of the flap: knit 2 together before each corner and ssk after each corner. That is 4 stitches per decrease round. Repeat every other round, 3 decrease rounds in all, until you have the stitch count in the last column. Work 1 round in knit.

4 • THE SOLE AND THE TIES

Divide the stitches evenly between the top and the sole. Shape the toe by knitting 2 together at each side every other round, until the number in your column remains on each part. Check the foot length against the last column before finishing the decreases. Turn the bootie inside out and graft the two parts together, or cast off and sew them with mattress stitch.

Size	Stitches left	Top / sole	Decrease toe to	Foot length
Small	24 sts	12 / 12 sts	2 x 6 sts	7,5 cm
Medium	34 sts	17 / 17 sts	2 x 9 sts	10,0 cm
Large	46 sts	23 / 23 sts	2 x 12 sts	12,5 cm
Extra large	58 sts	29 / 29 sts	2 x 15 sts	14,5 cm

I-CORD AND SECOND BOOTIE

Cast on 3 stitches in green and work an i-cord to the length in the size table. Thread it through the eyelet round and tie a loose bow at the front. Work the second bootie exactly the same, and check that the flap has the same number of rows on both.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the booties is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Chest after washing

Time taken, roughly

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Total length after washing

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- The ties are used under supervision only, and are tied loosely, never tightened.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.

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